

LDT4SSC Project Methodology

Step 2: VALIDATE (Specifications)

Data Governance Workshop

**Workshop: Understanding Data
Governance and Setting the
Goal: From Vision to a First
Actionable Roadmap**

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Document History

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May 2026	v1	Marine Le Gall, Laura Riou, Sophie Houzet	First version adapted from the CAPACities program.

Workshop Overview

Title	Understanding Data Governance and Setting the Goal: From Vision to a First Actionable Roadmap
Methodological step	Step 2: VALIDATE (Specifications)
Duration	2 hours
Number of Facilitators	1 for each group of 4 to 5 people
Equipment Needed	• One big sheet of paper (1m/2m) or a large (digital) whiteboard • sticky-notes • Pens and markers
Expected outputs	• A shared definition and scope of data governance • A future-state vision (success and failure scenarios) • A preliminary list of required actions for a data governance strategy and roadmap • A summary note produced after the workshop, outlining key findings and next steps.

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1. Context and objectives

The **Understanding Data Governance and Setting the Goal** workshop is part of the **VALIDATE step (specification)** which bridges the gap between the project's initial idea and its practical implementation. It translates the use cases into **technical and functional requirements**, while accounting for real-world constraints such as interoperability, data, architecture, security, and putting the user's needs at the center.

More information on the objectives, prerequisites and stakeholders to involve in the EXPLORE step can be found on the LDT4SSC Knowledge Hub¹.

The workshop is designed to achieve the following objectives:

- **Clarify the concept of data governance** by defining its key principles, components and significance within the consortium.
- **Collectively** imagine and describe an ideal scenario where data governance is fully and successfully implemented.
- **Determine the essential actions** required to achieve this ideal scenario.
- **Identify potential obstacles** that could impede effective data governance.
- **Develop practical solutions** to address these challenges.

2. Workshop

2.1. Workshop phases overview

<i>Time spent</i>	<i>Phase</i>	<i>Description</i>
10 mins	0. Framing and Icebreaker	Participants revisit the selected use case and project objectives to keep discussions grounded.
30 mins	1. Brainstorming on Data Governance	Participants individually reflect on their understanding of data governance issues, while the facilitator collects, groups and summarises the ideas.
30 mins	2. Envisioning Different Scenarios	Participants envision themselves in five years: either the ideal fit-for-purpose data governance has been set up, or a failing one was set up.
30 mins	3. Understanding both the Actions taken to Achieve Success and the Missteps that Led to Failure	Participants map the critical stages —successes and pitfalls— over five years to shape actionable data governance strategies.
15 mins	4. Synthesising Outcomes and Defining Next Phases	Each subgroup presents its timeline and key insights, while the facilitator synthesises the discussion and defines follow-up actions.

¹ https://knowledgehub.ldt4ssc.eu/resources_content/methodology/

2.2. Workshop step by step guide

Phase 0: Framing and Icebreaker (recommended allocated time: 10 mins)

The facilitator orients the participants **towards the selected use case** and the overarching project objectives. They list all **relevant project factors** such as: goals, stakeholders, budget. This initial phase ensures that the subsequent discussions remain grounded in a **clear and concrete context**.

The facilitator further establishes a **shared understanding** of the session's objectives, phases, and expected outputs. This includes clarifying the collaborative nature of the workshop, defining key terms such as **data governance, data management, and data strategy**, and introducing the method used, which combines **future projection and backcasting** to guide the discussion.

The facilitator also **organises an icebreaker** designed to foster mental and creative engagement by encouraging participants to adopt a playful, and open mindset. This initial interactive, game-like activity, stimulates imaginative thinking, reduces initial social tension, and prepares participants to engage fully in subsequent workshop phases.

Phase 1: Brainstorming on Data Governance (recommended allocated time: 30 mins)

In this phase, participants individually brainstorm and jot down their ideas on sticky notes about what **data governance encompasses**. Each participant writes one idea per sticky note on what data governance covers in the context of the LDT project.



Figure 1. The European Interoperability Framework (EIF) 4 layer interoperability model.

After 20 minutes, the facilitator collects and **groups these notes by theme, revealing the common dimensions of data governance**. For instance:

- **Technical & semantic:** quality, processing, accessibility, management, AI, security, data management, hosting, backup, etc.
- **Organisational:** trust, general interest, transparency, network management, citizen participation, change-management, financial valuation, etc.

- **Legal:** respect of data regulations, liability, contracts, public procurements, managing intellectual property, general conditions, legal clauses, etc.

These themes are then summarised and aligned with a **predefined framework** such as the EIF, which the facilitator presents to the group to ensure a shared baseline understanding.

Phase 2: Envisioning Different Scenarios (recommended allocated time: 30 mins)

The group is split by the facilitator into two subgroups for this phase.

1. The first subgroup envisions an **ideal 5 years ahead future** where data governance is fully successful, listing all the elements that contribute to this success; and
2. the second subgroup explores a **failed scenario**, detailing the consequences of inadequate data governance **after five years**.

Phase 3: Understanding both the Actions taken to Achieve Success and the Missteps that Led to Failure (recommended allocated time: 30 mins)

Here, both subgroups reflect on their scenarios, and list all the actions it took to achieve either the ideal future, or the failed scenario.

1. The first group outlines the **actions taken to achieve success**;
2. while the second identifies the **missteps or oversights that led to failure**.

All participants then place these actions on a **shared timeline**, mapping out the critical stages over the five-year period.

Phase 4: Synthetising Outcomes and Defining Next Steps (recommended allocated time: 15 minutes)

The workshop concludes with each subgroup presenting its timeline and key insights. The facilitator synthesises the discussion, highlighting **common actions, risks, and dependencies**, and connects the outcomes to **concrete next steps** for implementing or improving data governance.

2.3. Recommendations for Workshop facilitation

To ensure the workshop's effectiveness, facilitators are advised to adopt the following approaches:

Prepare Thoroughly for Focused Discussions

To ensure that the workshop is productive, the facilitator should make sure to dedicate time in advance to understand key terms such as **data governance, data management, and data strategy**, and the method used. The discussion can be tailored to fit the specific context and objectives of the LDT project. This preparation will allow them to guide discussions with precision, ensuring that the conversation remains relevant, structured, and aligned with the

goals they aim to achieve. By adapting the framework to the project's unique needs, it creates a foundation for focused and meaningful exchanges.

Assess the Structural Framework of Data Governance

It is advised to initiate discussions by examining how the organisation has **structured its approach to data governance**, particularly whether an **internal or external committee** has been established to oversee these efforts. Clarifying the existence and mandate of such a body provides insight into the **formal commitment** to governance and sets the stage for evaluating its effectiveness.

Stimulate discussion

To foster meaningful discussion and self-reflection among participants, facilitators may find the following questions useful in guiding the conversation and assessing the maturity of data governance within the organisation. There is no fixed order —facilitators should **tailor them to the needs of the group**.

Examples of questions for facilitators

- How has your organisation structured its approach to data governance —have you established an **internal or external committee** dedicated to overseeing it in the context of the LDT project ?
- To what extent do you have **political and managerial support** for your data governance efforts, and how is this support demonstrated in practice?
- Do you currently have a **dedicated team** responsible for data governance, or are responsibilities distributed across various departments? If so, how are these roles coordinated?
- Have any **new roles** been created within the local authorities specifically to address data governance, and what are their key responsibilities?
- How have you ensured that **all staff members** are aware of the importance and implications of data governance within their roles?
- Have you developed a **comprehensive inventory and map of your data assets**, and is this map designed to be scalable as your data needs evolve?
- Does your organisation have a **clearly defined data-centric strategy** that aligns with your broader objectives, and how is this strategy communicated and implemented?
- Are your **elected representatives able to request the creation of custom indicators** on demand to support their decision-making processes, and how is this facilitated?
- Do all departments within your organisation follow a **consistent methodology** for sharing and reusing data, or are there disparities in how data is managed across teams?

- Is there a **centralised platform** in place that enables departments to share and promote data effectively, and if so, how is this platform utilised?
- How do you currently **manage data access rights**, and what measures are in place to ensure compliance with data protection regulations such as GDPR?
- Have you implemented all the **necessary technical elements** to support robust data management, including compliance with GDPR, open data publication, and other regulatory requirements?
- Do you have **standardised clauses or contracts** prepared for use in new projects to ensure consistency and compliance with data governance policies?
- Has your data governance framework succeeded in connecting different **business lines and staff** within the organisation, and if so, how has this integration improved collaboration?
- How do you currently **collaborate with external partners** on data-related initiatives, and what mechanisms are in place to ensure these collaborations are effective and aligned with your governance goals?
- Have you established a **continuing training programme** to ensure that staff members remain informed and skilled in data governance practices as they evolve?

3. Next steps

The following workshops for the VALIDATE step are:

- *2.2.2 Mapping Stakeholders' Legitimacy and Authority to act in Data Governance: Understand Roles, Responsibilities, and Hierarchical Influence*
- *2.2.3 Designing your Data Governance Roadmap: From Data Officer Mission Statement to Action*
- *2.2.4 Complementing your Data Governance Roadmap with a Legal Framework: From Mapping Legal Phases to Action*
- *2.2.5 Refining your Legal Framework for Data Governance: Deep dive into legal and contractual requirements*
- *2.3 Inventorying your LDT Project Data: Unlocking Interoperability, Listing and committing to share data among partners*
- *2.4 Identifying Levers, Obstacles and Objectives for Interoperability: From Awareness to Actionable Strategies for LDT Projects*
- *Bonus: Lego® Serious Play: A Transversal Tool to Address and Overcome Data Governance Challenges*

NB: The *Bonus: Lego® Serious Play* workshop is a workshop aimed at unwrapping bottlenecks via the usage of Legos, so it can be paired with any and all workshops in the VALIDATE step.

Next Methodology steps:

- *Done: Complete the EXPLORE workshops*
- *Ongoing: Complete the VALIDATE workshops*
- Complete the DEFINE workshops
- Complete the IMPLEMENT workshops

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